

THE EQUITY EXPRESSION OF THE URANIUM THESIS

The Price Nobody Trades

The long-term uranium contract price closed August at \$96.50 a pound, the highest nominal level on record, and utilities signed a fifth more term volume in the first half than a year earlier. Over the same stretch the Global X Uranium ETF fell to \$40.04, more than a third below its 52-week high, and Cameco trades 36% below its own. The question is no longer whether uranium is scarce. It is which of uranium's several prices the equity market is actually pricing.

A reframe worth holding onto

The internal view, carried almost entirely by 13D Research and seconded by Goehring & Rozencwajg, is that the uranium equity sell-off is a "category error": the shares have been traded as an appendage of the AI data-centre trade, while the market that actually clears most of the metal — private, multi-year term contracts — has kept tightening. On that reading the tape is measuring fashion, and the term price is measuring the fuel.

That is a view, not a finding. It is tested below against the producers' own realised prices.

Method. External figures — prices, results, contract volumes — are drawn from company releases, fund disclosures and market-data pages and carry their as-of dates. Internal views come from the Heyokha Wiki's Uranium theme page (last reviewed 25 September 2026) and the provider issues it cites, and are labelled by provider. Where the two disagree, the disagreement is stated, not settled.

Picture a Saskatchewan wheat farm that sells almost its entire crop to a flour mill on five-year contracts. The contracts have a floor and a ceiling, and each year's delivery is priced off an average of recent markets, so the cheque always arrives late to any price move. The mill has just signed its newest contracts at the highest price in the farm's history. But the farm's shares are not priced off the mill. They are priced off the chalkboard at the local grain elevator, where a handful of traders swap a few truckloads on a quiet Tuesday — and off whether bakeries are in fashion that month. When bakery stocks fall, so does the farm, whatever the mill just agreed to pay. Uranium in September 2026 is that farm.

THE STORY IN 60 SECONDS

\$96.50/lb

Long-term contract price at end-August, a nominal record; spot sat at \$89.68. *Cameco industry averages, 31 Aug 2026.*

–35.7%

URA from its 52-week high of \$62.28 to \$40.04; down 13.3% year to date. *Global X URA, close 29 Sep 2026.*

32.5 Mlb

Term volume signed industry-wide in 1H26, against 27 Mlb a year earlier. *Kazatomprom 2Q26 trading update, Aug 2026.*

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

A record in one market, a rout in the other

Uranium does not change hands on an exchange. Buyers and sellers negotiate privately, and the prices on screens are assembled by two consultancies, UxC and TradeTech, from what they can observe. There are two headline numbers. The spot price covers deliveries within a year and is set in a thin market dominated by traders, hedgers and financial vehicles. The term price reflects multi-year contracts between miners and the utilities that run reactors. Goehring & Rozencwajg

put the term market at roughly 90% of volume; 13D puts it at about 80%. Either way, the spot price is the one quoted and the term price is the one that pays.

Through 2026 the two have moved apart. Spot peaked in January at \$94.28 at month-end, slid to \$84.18 by May, and has since recovered to \$89.68 at the end of August and about \$89.50 on US futures on 29 September — up 9% on the year but still below January. The term price rose in almost every month, from \$89.00 in January to \$96.50 in August. Sprott's latest report, published 24 September, describes the long-term price as having passed the previous cycle's high. Contracting activity confirms it is not a stale quote: Kazatomprom counted 32.5 million pounds of term business in the first half, 20% more than a year earlier.

The equities went the other way. Uranium miners rallied 17% in August, according to Sprott, then gave it back. 13D's own Uranium Index fell 6.9% in the week to 13 September and 8.5% the week after, and sat in the detractor column for a third straight week to 24 September. By the close on 29 September, Cameco was at \$86.88, BWX Technologies at \$138.01, Centrus Energy at \$138.18 and Oklo at \$37.11 — drawdowns from 52-week highs of 36%, 43%, 70% and 81% respectively. The Sprott Physical Uranium Trust, which simply holds pounds in a vault, trades at a 13.2% discount to the value of those pounds.

What changed in the background is the price of money. The Federal Reserve raised its target range to 3.75–4.00% on 16 September, its first increase since 2023, and the ten-year Treasury yield returned to about 5%. Uranium equities are, in large part, claims on cash that arrives late in the decade: NexGen's Rook I is scheduled to produce around 2030, Centrus's enrichment expansion targets 2029, and the Army's first microreactor is due in September 2028. A higher discount rate hurts such claims more than it hurts a current-year commodity price. That is one mechanical reason for the split, and it does not require the uranium thesis to be wrong.

THE ESSENTIAL DISTINCTION

There is no single uranium price. Spot is a thin market in near-term pounds; term is the negotiated price of the next decade's supply; and the *realised* price is what a miner actually books this quarter, after floors, ceilings and averaging. The term price has hit a record. Realised prices have not — and it is realised prices, not records, that reach earnings.

THE MECHANISM

Following one pound from the ground to the income statement

The gap between the record and the rout is easiest to see by tracing a single pound. Kazatomprom, the Kazakh state producer and the largest by volume, is the cleanest example because it discloses both its costs and what it realised. In the first half of 2026 it booked an average of \$67.88 a pound at group level. The average month-end spot price over the same months was \$86.83. The producer that supplies well over 40% of the world's mined uranium, in G&R's estimate, realised about 22% less than the headline spot price and roughly 30% less than the term price.

The reason is contract design. Most producer sales are "market-related": the delivery price is set off a trailing average of spot or term indicators, bounded by a floor and a ceiling, and escalated for inflation. Cameco told investors in July that its market-related contracts carry floors in the high \$70s and ceilings around \$160 a pound. That structure protected producers when prices were low and delays their benefit now. A record term price signed today mostly lifts deliveries in 2028 and beyond.



Sources: Kazatomprom 2Q26 operations and trading update and 1H26 financial results (August 2026); Cameco Q2 2026 results and investor materials (31 July 2026). Step 4 is 13D Research's view as recorded on the Heyokha Wiki, not a verified figure.

The same arithmetic runs in reverse for financial buyers. Sprott Physical Uranium Trust held 81.7 million pounds on 29 September, with net assets of \$7.40 billion — about \$90.58 a pound. Its units traded at a 13.2% discount to that value, which means the listed market was paying roughly \$78.60 for a pound the trust itself marks at \$90.58. The discount matters beyond arithmetic. The trust generally raises new money and buys physical pounds when its units trade at or above net asset value; at a discount of this size, one of the more reliable marginal buyers in the spot market is sidelined. The weak equity tape, in other words, can feed back into a softer spot price, not merely reflect one.

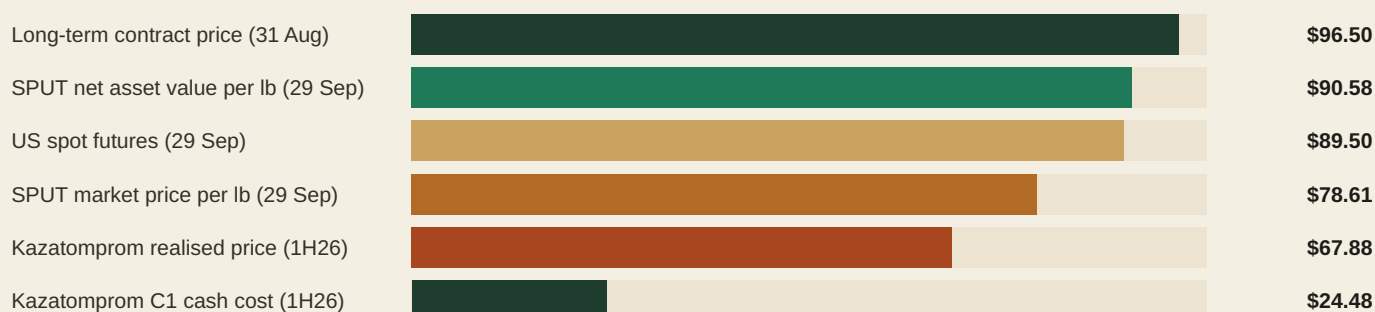


Sources: Cameco uranium price page (31 Aug 2026); Kazatomprom 2Q26 trading update (Aug 2026); Sprott Physical Uranium Trust fund data (29 Sep 2026).

THE CENTRAL COMPARISON

What a pound is worth, depending on who is asked

Laid side by side, the prices tell the story of a market that agrees on scarcity and disagrees on almost everything else. The spread from the term record to the producer's realised price is nearly \$29 a pound; the spread from the trust's own valuation to what the market pays for its units is another \$12. Each gap is a place where the bull case has to wait.



Bars are illustrative, scaled to \$100/lb. SPUT per-pound figures are derived: net assets of \$7.40bn divided by 81,697,348 lb, and that value reduced by the published 13.21% discount. Sources: Cameco; Trading Economics; Sprott; Kazatomprom. Dates as shown.

A USEFUL MENTAL MODEL

Treat spot as the weather, term as the climate, and the realised price as the harvest. The climate has turned. The weather is changeable. The harvest arrives two or three seasons late — and uranium equities, priced daily, keep mistaking the weather for the climate in *both* directions.

WHAT HAS ACTUALLY SHIFTED

Six changes since the summer

WHAT HAS CHANGED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA	WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
Term price at a nominal record	\$96.50/lb end-August, from \$89.00 in January (Cameco). Still below 2007's \$136 peak, per Sprott.	Confirms utilities are paying up for security; but it lifts deliveries years out, and in real terms the record is modest.
Utilities are contracting again	32.5 Mlb signed in 1H26 vs 27 Mlb (Kazatomprom). US coverage falls from 60% in 2030 to 9% by 2033 (Sprott).	A contracting wave is the classic bull signal; but G&R's estimate of ~175 Mlb of annual reactor need shows the pace is still short of replacement.
Producer costs are rising	Kazatomprom C1 cost +37% to \$24.48/lb; extraction tax up to 12.4%; acid plant delayed to Q3 2027–Q1 2028.	Supply discipline supports price; but cost inflation squeezes the margin that equities are meant to capture.
Money got dearer	Fed raised to 3.75–4.00% on 16 September; ten-year Treasury around 5%.	Hurts long-dated developers most; but a hawkish, inflation-fighting regime is the hard-asset backdrop 13D argues for.
Military demand became concrete	US Army Janus programme: five vendors, up to \$2.2bn, first reactor targeted for 30 Sep 2028 (13D, via the Wiki).	Creates an anchor customer for microreactors; but volumes are tiny and fuel — HALEU — is the binding constraint.
Listed nuclear paper is multiplying	Westinghouse filed confidentially for a US IPO (Cameco, 31 July); Oklo announced a \$1bn at-the-market offering.	Price discovery for reactor assets; but new supply of nuclear equity competes for the same thematic capital.

Two coherent readings of the same data

The bull case

- **The price that matters is rising.** Term has climbed in almost every month of 2026 to a nominal record of \$96.50, and term volume is up 20% year on year. Spot and equities are the noisier signals.
- **A coverage cliff is coming.** Sprott's data show US utility coverage falling from 60% in 2030 to 9% by 2033, and European coverage from 100% to 36% by 2034. Those pounds have to be bought.
- **The largest producer has stopped chasing volume.** Kazatomprom's shift to "value over volume", its acid-plant delay and a 37% jump in unit costs all point to tighter supply, per G&R and the company's own disclosures.
- **Demand is insensitive to price.** In 13D's view fuel is 4–8% of reactor operating cost, so utilities pay what is needed. China's build-out and the Army's Janus programme add demand that is not tied to AI sentiment.
- **The contrarian gauge is flashing buy.** G&R read spot below term as evidence that speculators have washed out; spot sat about 7% below term at end-August.
- **The listed discount is an opportunity, on this view.** Physical uranium via SPUT at a 13% discount, and Cameco 36% off its high while its contract book re-prices upward, is what a mispricing would look like.

The bear case

- **Supply has responded more than the thesis allows.** Sprott itself notes mine production rose about 60 Mlb, roughly 50%, between 2020 and 2026 as prices tripled. That is not an inelastic supply curve.
- **Records are not reaching earnings.** Kazatomprom realised \$67.88 in 1H26 against spot near \$87. Cameco's Q2 adjusted EPS of \$0.13 missed a \$0.28 consensus. Contract lags cap the near-term payoff.
- **Spot has not confirmed.** Spot at about \$89.50 is still below January's \$94.28 and the cycle peak of \$107 Sprott cites. If term is right, spot has yet to agree.
- **The marginal financial buyer is sidelined.** With SPUT at a 13% discount, the vehicle that absorbed ~10 Mlb over the past year cannot readily issue units to buy more, removing support from spot.
- **The equities are long-duration and crowded.** With ten-year yields near 5%, projects paying out around 2030 are worth less. Oklo's \$1bn offering and a Westinghouse IPO add supply of nuclear paper.
- **The AI link cuts both ways.** G&R call the AI association a category error, but it is how much of the money arrived. If AI capex sentiment cools further, the flows that lifted the shares can leave faster than utilities sign contracts.

Sourcing note: the Wiki's "bear case" section on this page is thin — three short, generic scenarios (an accident, cheaper renewables plus storage, elastic supply) and no dated evidence. The bear column above was therefore built from external reporting and from tensions inside the producers' own disclosures, as the method requires.

Where the internal and external views diverge

The sharpest conflict is over timing. On 6 September 13D read Cameco as "forming a textbook inverse head-and-shoulders bottom", with a measured target near \$150, about 50% above the price then. Three weeks later Cameco closed at \$86.88, and 13D's Uranium Index has since had three consecutive losing weeks. The Wiki records this as "an open question about the timing of the technical call rather than a reversal of the thesis". The external record is less forgiving: the setup has so far failed. A second, deeper tension sits in the supply argument. The Wiki's structural case rests on a deficit of 30–50 Mlb a year that "cannot be closed quickly", yet Sprott — a bullish source — reports that mine output grew by about half as prices tripled. Both may be true at once if the easy restarts are now exhausted and greenfield projects need far higher prices, which is Sprott's own argument. But that is a claim about the future, and the data so far show supply responding. A smaller discrepancy: the Wiki, via 13D citing the Wall Street Journal, dates Westinghouse's confidential IPO filing to early September; Cameco's own announcement is dated 31 July. None of these is resolved here.

WHAT TO WATCH FROM HERE

A dashboard for the next test

SIGNAL	PLAIN-ENGLISH READING	WHY IT MATTERS
September month-end term price (early October)	Does the long-term price hold at or above \$96.50, or does it stall?	The bull case rests almost entirely on term. A flat or lower print would weaken the "climate has turned" reading.
Spot versus term spread	Spot was ~7% below term at end-August; G&R treat a discount as bullish, a premium as bearish.	Convergence upward would validate term; a widening gap would suggest term is running ahead of physical demand.
SPUT discount to NAV	13.2% on 29 September. Narrowing lets the trust buy pounds again.	The trust is a swing buyer in spot. Its discount is a direct read of whether financial demand is returning.
Cameco Q3 results (30 October)	Realised price per pound, new term volumes, Westinghouse contribution.	The first chance to see whether the term record is reaching a Western producer's earnings.
Centrus (4 November) and Oklo (10 November) results	HALEU progress, contract wins, cash burn and dilution.	The fuel-cycle and reactor names fell hardest; their results test whether policy support is turning into revenue.
Ten-year Treasury yield around 5%	Whether the September hike marks the top of the rate cycle or the start of more.	Long-duration nuclear equities trade on the discount rate as much as on uranium.

THREE POSTURES, NOT ONE ANSWER

Ways the theme can be expressed — and what each costs

The metal, at a discount

Hold physical uranium through a listed trust that trades below the value of its pounds. This isolates the commodity and captures any narrowing of the discount. **The cost:** no earnings or dividends, a management fee, exposure to spot rather than term, and a discount that can widen further if financial buyers stay away.

The contract book

Own an established producer whose term book re-prices upward over years, accepting the lag in exchange for operating leverage and a stake in reactor services. **The cost:** contract ceilings and averaging cap the upside, results can miss (as Q2 did), and a trailing valuation well above 100 times earnings leaves little room for error.

The fuel-cycle option

Own enrichment, reactor and development names tied to HALEU, microreactors and new mines. This is the purest bet on the policy build-out. **The cost:** execution and licensing risk, dilution, heavy sensitivity to interest rates, and drawdowns of 70–80% already seen this year.

The companies below are illustrative names chosen to show how the theme is expressed across the fuel cycle. They are NOT recommendations, and nothing here is advice to buy, sell or hold any security.

CCJ**Cameco Corporation**\$86.88
close 29 Sep 2026

The largest listed Western producer, with 2026 production guidance of 19.5–21.5 Mlb and 49% of Westinghouse. Q2 adjusted EPS of \$0.13 missed a \$0.28 consensus. Its market-related contracts carry floors in the high \$70s and ceilings near \$160. The shares are 36% below their 52-week high of \$135.24 and 13D's ~\$150 technical target has not been met.

WATCH NEXT

Q3 results on 30 October: realised price per pound and the volume of new term contracts signed.

KAP**NAC Kazatomprom**\$67.88/lb realised
1H 2026

The largest producer by volume. 1H26 attributable production was 18.34 Mlb and group sales 19.72 Mlb. Unit costs rose 37% to \$24.48/lb on higher extraction tax and acid prices, and its sulphuric acid plant has slipped 6–12 months. The company's own line is that pricing power "has returned to producers with proven and large uranium reserves".

WATCH NEXT

The next trading update, and any change to production intentions for 2027.

U.U**Sprott Physical Uranium Trust**–13.21% to NAV
29 Sep 2026

Holds 81.7 Mlb of U3O8 with net assets of \$7.40bn; units last traded at \$18.67 against NAV of \$21.51. The trust took roughly 10 Mlb off the market between mid-2025 and early 2026, per G&R, and is among the most important swing buyers in spot. The present discount largely prevents new purchases.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the discount narrows enough for the trust to resume buying physical pounds.

NXE**NexGen Energy**\$9.03
close 29 Sep 2026

Owner of Rook I in Saskatchewan, approved by the Canadian regulator and targeting ~25 Mlb a year from around 2030. G&R note that NexGen has contracted only a small share of output, preferring price exposure. It is the clearest long-duration uranium claim, and 35% below its 52-week high of \$13.96.

WATCH NEXT

Construction milestones and any offtake or partnership agreement that fixes Rook I's price exposure.

LEU**Centrus Energy**\$138.18
close 29 Sep 2026

Operator of the only active US HALEU production capability, with a \$900m DOE task order to expand Piketon toward a planned 12 tons a year by 2029, per 13D. It has signed multi-year HALEU supply contracts with Antares and Radiant. The shares are down 70% from a 52-week high of \$464.25.

WATCH NEXT

Q3 results on 4 November: HALEU contract revenue and the pace of Piketon expansion.

BWXT**BWX Technologies**\$138.01
close 29 Sep 2026

Sole supplier of naval reactors to the US Navy, a TRISO fuel producer, and one of the five Janus microreactor vendors (Fort Campbell). Backlog has doubled to \$8.4bn per company materials, and it held an investor day on 29 September. The shares are 43% below their 52-week high of \$241.82.

WATCH NEXT

Q3 results (early November): commercial nuclear orders and Janus milestone payments.

The bottom line

What was repriced this quarter was not uranium. It was the time it takes uranium's scarcity to reach a shareholder. The term price rose to a record while the realised price, the spot tape and the listed vehicles lagged, and a Fed that raised rates while ten-year yields touched 5% made every year of that lag more expensive. The equities fell because the harvest is late and money is dear, not because the climate reversed.

The evidence is mixed. Term contracting is strong, but supply has grown faster than the structural case implies, producers' realised prices sit well below the headlines, and 13D's September technical call has so far failed. The reasonable inference is that the internal thesis on scarcity has not been refuted, while the internal thesis on timing has been. The next test is concrete: whether Cameco's results on 30 October show the term record arriving in realised prices, and whether SPUT's discount narrows enough to bring the marginal buyer back to spot.

Editorial note. This Market Field Guide is educational commentary prepared for internal use. It is not investment advice, research, or a recommendation to buy, sell or hold any security or commodity. Companies named are illustrative of how a theme is expressed and are not recommendations. External figures are dated and attributed to their sources; they may have changed since. Internal views drawn from the Heyokha Wiki are the opinions of the named research providers and are labelled as views, not forecasts or verified facts. Where internal and external evidence conflict, the conflict is stated and deliberately left unresolved.

Sources and update notes

Internal. Heyokha Wiki theme page *Uranium* (created 23 June 2026; last reviewed 25 September 2026), sections Thesis; Mechanism; The bear case & what breaks it; Contradictions; July 2026; August 2026; September 2026; May 2026 (Kazatomprom); and August 2026 (G&R spot-vs-term). Company page *Cameco* (created and last reviewed 23 June 2026). Provider issues relied on: 13D Research WILTW of 24 September, 17 September, 10 September and 2 July 2026; 13D WATMTU of 20 September, 13 September, 6 September, 16 August and 9 August 2026; Goehring & Rozencwajg Q2 2026 Natural Resource Market Commentary (28 August 2026) and Q1 2026 commentary (19 May 2026). Earlier 13D issues from 2022–2025 inform the page's thesis sections but were not relied on for any figure here.

Limitation on the internal view. The Wiki's uranium page is close to a single-provider document. Of the 38 sources listed in its frontmatter, 37 are 13D Research issues; the other is a Goehring & Rozencwajg letter, with a second G&R letter cited in the body. Both providers are long-standing uranium bulls, and 13D runs a Uranium Index and a Special Opportunities Strategy that hold the names discussed. The page's own Contradictions section reads "None yet — only 13D sources in the compilation window." Greed & Fear, Solid Ground, White Box and the other providers the Wiki tracks contribute nothing to this page. The internal view should therefore be read as one well-argued advocacy position, not a consensus.

External. (1) Cameco, uranium price page: spot \$89.68/lb and long-term \$96.50/lb at 31 Aug 2026; 2026 month-end series from \$94.28 spot / \$89.00 term in January. (2) Trading Economics: uranium futures \$89.50/lb on 29 Sep 2026, +9.21% year on year. (3) Sprott, "Record Term Prices Mark a New Phase for Uranium" (24 Sep 2026): term ~\$96/lb at 31 Aug, 2007 high \$136, cycle peak \$107, miners +17.29% in August, US coverage 60% (2030) to 9% (2033), European 100% (2030) to 36% (2034), mine output +~60 Mlb (~50%) 2020–26. (4) Sprott Physical Uranium Trust fund data, 29 Sep 2026: 81,697,348 lb, NAV \$21.51, market \$18.67, discount 13.21%, net assets \$7.40bn. (5) Kazatomprom 2Q26 operations and trading update (August 2026): group realised \$67.88/lb, month-end spot average \$86.83, 1H26 term volume 32.5 Mlb vs 27 Mlb, attributable production 18.34 Mlb, group sales 19.72 Mlb. (6) Kazatomprom 1H26 financial results (21 Aug 2026): C1 cost \$24.48/lb (+37%), extraction tax 9% to 12.4%, TQZ acid plant delayed to Q3 2027–Q1 2028. (7) Cameco Q2 2026 results (31 Jul 2026) and investor materials as reported by Investing.com: adjusted EPS \$0.13 vs \$0.28 consensus, 2026 production guidance 19.5–21.5 Mlb, floors high \$70s and ceilings ~\$160. (8) Cameco, Westinghouse confidential S-1 submission (31 Jul 2026). (9) StockAnalysis.com closing prices, 29 Sep 2026: CCJ \$86.88 (52-week high \$135.24; next earnings 30 Oct); URA \$40.04 (high \$62.28; YTD –13.26%); LEU \$138.18 (high \$464.25; earnings 4 Nov); OKLO \$37.11 (high \$193.84; earnings 10 Nov; \$1bn ATM offering); BWXT \$138.01 (high \$241.82; backlog \$8.4bn); NXE \$9.03 (high \$13.96). (10) CNBC and Schwab, 16 Sep 2026: Fed target range raised to 3.75–4.00%, ten-year Treasury back to about 5%. (11) XTB (7 Jul 2026), for the earlier leg of the equity drawdown.

Editorial choices made in this automated run. The archive folder was read via the device bridge; every edition in the 30 days to 30 September formed the cooldown set. Higher-scoring themes skipped on cooldown: Gold, AI Capex, Oil & Gas, India Equities, Critical Minerals, Copper, China Equities, China AI and Silver. Food Security scored highest among eligible themes, but the 31 August "Grain Supply Shock" edition sits on the 30-day boundary and was treated as the same theme. Uranium, Iran War and Gold Miners then tied; Uranium was chosen as it last ran on 11 August and overlaps least with the recent Gold and Oil & Gas editions. No Wiki source was published in the last three days. The Wiki bear case was thin and was built from external sources. September's month-end term price was not yet published; Cameco's Q2 realised price could not be verified and was omitted. No tool failures affected the content.